those chosen people to have a God. The Hindus and other non-Christians should not be blamed for this. According to Zaehner, the great weakness of the Indians is that with them "The question of the existence and nature of God is, when all is said and done, of secondary importance" (p. 43). "Basically they are not interested in what we would call 'God' at all" or still, "they do not teach you very much about God, but they do teach you a great deal about the immortality of the soul and the Absolute (p. 57). His reason for making such a palpably false statement is that he finds the hitherto Indian philosophical literature published in English full of phrases like the Yogic Samādhi, Jain Arhathood, Advaitic absorbtion into Brahman, self-realization, etc. It has already been pointed out that, since non-theistic trends have existed in India alongside the theistic ones, it does not follow that God does not exist in India or that he is of secondary importance. In the West, too, many forms of agnostic or atheistic schools of philosophy thrive, but no one draws the conclusion that there is therefore no God in Christianity.

His great complaint against Hinduism is that in it we do not find "anything at all comparable to the old testament idea of an intensely personal God operating in and through His people in history. The old testament is revelation in the strictest sense; God progressively reveals His purpose to His chosen people, and there is always a looking forward to the coming of the Kingdom of God at the end of time, when Israel will be restored to its rightful greatness" (p. 69). The Hindus are glad that they cannot subscribe to any such totally unacceptable revelation of religion.

One of Zaehner's new ways of distorting Hinduism is that he sets Buddhism against Hinduism on the score of the Buddha's non-admittance of the existence of the Absolute of the Upaniṣads of the Hindus. While this certainly is a point of opposition between the Buddhistic philosophy and the Absolutism of the Upaniṣads prevalent in the Buddha's time, it has never been a point of opposition between Hinduism and Buddhism as religions. In Indian philosophical and religious literature, Buddhism has always been called an atheistic school whose meaning certainly cannot be only unbelief in the Absolute. In India, the Buddhists have always been called atheists and not non-absolutists. Why should Zaehner not emphasize the atheism of the Buddha against the theism of the Hindus rather than make capital of the differences between them only on the problem of the doctrine of momentariness versus the principle of permanence passes comprehension? To continue, "Hinduism and Buddhism, on the other hand, are not vitally